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ALL THE EDITOR'S MEN

Vanity in a newspaper man is like perfume on a whore: they use it to fend off a dark whiff of themselves. I say that as an editor who loves what journalists can do. But I would be failing to give a true account of things in this book if I did not bear witness – sore witness at times – to the way senior journalists from the English-speaking world have serially loved WikiLeaks and then mugged us, almost without missing a beat, and then justified their actions with articles and books that must make them ridiculous in their own eyes. I bear them no deep resentment, but only mourn, as they must, the failing light of their principles in this last attempt to shine.

Everybody who likes a cause likes the *Guardian*, and I am no different, finding the paper to be a beacon sometimes, especially since it increased its global presence online. After the events of 9/11, the *Guardian* was the only truthful newspaper available in America, and I think I always admired its attempt to see the world, rather than just to see itself in the world, which is a trait you can't take for granted. The *Guardian* had gone after corrupt politicians and reported the horror of war with a consistency that won't diminish as a result of their infamous venality over me. The *Guardian* is basically twelve angry men, and they function well and morally to the same extent that they sometimes behave selfishly and appallingly. There is no mystery there, and I have always been happy to see what they can achieve on a good day. They seemed a natural ally, but, as Shakespeare tells it, there is nothing in nature to match an ally's fierce intent.

There was a hullabaloo when we came into partnership in 2010 over the Afghan war logs, but we had actually worked together before, in 2007, when I supplied them with a leak about the corruption of Daniel Arap Moi in Kenya. It ran as a front-page story at the end of August and beginning of September of that year and had a massive effect in Nairobi, where newspapers suddenly felt able to write about what was happening under